EFFICACY OF PROPAGANDA IN CONDUCTING INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

Political communication and the systemic use of psychological methods, of which propaganda is a prominent part, are nothing new in the history of international relations. It was the Roman Catholic Church which first used it and institutionalized it as the propagation of faith through a special Sacred Congregation (Congregation de Propaganda Fide, that is, the congregation of the Propagation of Faith), from the title of which the word 'propaganda' is derived. Though the British Government was the first to organize and systematize the use of propaganda at home and abroad during the First World War, it was the communists and then the Nazis who developed the mechanism of propaganda during the inter-war period. They built up such costly propaganda machineries that the Western democracies were forced to develop the same to match theirs. Post-Second World War and, even, in the present time, the states continue to use propaganda as a useful tool for statecraft.

In the United States, the agency incharge of propaganda activities is the United States Central Information Agency (CIA) and in the former Soviet Union it was the Agitation and Propaganda Section of the Central Committee of the Soviet Communist Party. British propaganda (officially referred to as *information services*), though it suffers from fund crunch, has been relatively successful in operating through decentralized organs, the Central Office of Information, the Overseas Services of the BBC, and also through the British Council. [30]

In the Soviet Union before World War II, after the Bolshevik revolution, they put into practice the process of 'indoctrination' on individual. For this, they used mechanisms of propaganda through party workers, the local Soviets of towns and villages, and the army. As Lenin wrote, as early as 1905: "Propaganda is of crucial importance for the triumph of the Party". Twelve years later he remarked that the revolution had succeeded "because it knew how to combine force with persuasion". The Soviets were masters in both developing propaganda devices and in adapting techniques to specific situations. The communist propaganda always had a